

MERIDIAN TECHNOLOGIES PVT. LTD.

Internal Policy Document

Code of Conduct

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1. Purpose

Intent of the Code

The Code of Conduct establishes the standards of behaviour expected from all employees, contractors, and representatives of Meridian Technologies. Adherence is a condition of continued employment.

The Code is the foundation on which the company's culture rests and provides the framework within which all other policies are interpreted.

Applicability

The Code applies at all times when the employee is on company premises, on company business off premises, or representing the company in any forum including social media.

Conduct in private personal life is generally outside the scope of the Code, except where it impinges on the reputation, integrity, or business interests of the company.

2. Core Values

The Five Values

Integrity, Respect, Accountability, Innovation, and Customer Centricity are the five core values. All employees are expected to act in accordance with these values in every business interaction.

Each value is elaborated in the People Handbook with examples of behaviours that exemplify it and behaviours that contradict it.

Living the Values

Living the values is a recognised criterion in the annual Performance Management process and is one of the behavioural competencies assessed at appraisal time.

Leaders are expected to role model the values and visibly recognise team members who demonstrate them in everyday work.

3. Workplace Behaviour

Non-Discrimination

Discrimination on the basis of gender, race, religion, caste, sexual orientation, disability, or age is strictly prohibited. The company is committed to providing a workplace free from harassment and bias.

Hiring, promotion, compensation, and other employment decisions are made on merit and demonstrated capability, with no reference to protected characteristics.

Substance Use and Premises

Use of intoxicants on company premises or during company business is prohibited. Smoking is permitted only in designated zones.

The company maintains the right to conduct reasonable testing where there is credible suspicion of substance use that may compromise safety or judgement.

4. Anti-Harassment and POSH

Statutory Framework

The Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) policy is fully adopted. An Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) is constituted at every location with more than 10 employees.

The ICC composition complies with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013, including an external member.

Complaint Process

Complaints must be filed in writing to the ICC within 3 months of the incident. The ICC will complete the inquiry within 90 days. Confidentiality is strictly maintained throughout.

Retaliation against a complainant or witness is itself a violation of this Code and may result in disciplinary action.

5. Conflict of Interest

Declaration Requirement

Employees must declare any potential conflict of interest in writing to the HR head. Examples include personal business ventures in competing fields, financial interest in vendors, and close family in supplier organisations.

An annual conflict declaration is conducted in April for all employees at the level of manager and above; supplementary declarations must be raised any time a new conflict arises.

Moonlighting

External employment (moonlighting) requires prior written approval from the Business Unit Head and HR. Unapproved external employment is treated as a serious breach of contract.

Voluntary, unpaid, social work generally does not require approval, except where the time commitment may impact the employee's primary role.

6. Confidentiality

Information Protection

Confidential business information, client data, source code, designs, and strategic plans must not be shared outside the company. The Non-Disclosure Agreement signed at the time of joining continues to apply for 3 years post separation.

Confidentiality obligations cover information acquired in any form, including through informal conversations, observation, or inadvertent disclosure.

Use of Information

Confidential information may be used only for the legitimate business purposes for which access was granted. Use for personal benefit or for the benefit of any third party is strictly prohibited.

7. Gifts and Hospitality

Acceptable Limits

Employees may accept token gifts from clients and vendors not exceeding Rs. 2,500 in value. Gifts exceeding this limit must be declined or surrendered to HR.

Hospitality (meals, event invitations) of reasonable value associated with legitimate business engagements is generally acceptable and need not be declared individually.

Strictly Prohibited

Cash, gift cards, and equivalent instruments must NEVER be accepted regardless of value.

Gifts during ongoing commercial negotiations, tenders, or contract awards are not acceptable even within the limit and must be politely declined.

8. Disciplinary Procedure

Categories of Misconduct

Minor misconduct is addressed through verbal counselling followed by a written warning. Repeated or serious misconduct leads to a formal show-cause notice and an inquiry.

Gross misconduct (fraud, theft, sexual harassment, breach of confidentiality, falsification of records) may lead to immediate termination without notice.

Inquiry Process

Disciplinary inquiries are conducted by an Inquiry Officer appointed by HR. The employee has the right to representation, written charge sheet, and a fair hearing.

The Inquiry Officer submits a report and recommendation to the HR Head, who makes the final decision after due deliberation.

9. Whistleblower Mechanism

Reporting Channels

Employees who become aware of fraud, financial irregularity, or breaches of this Code may report it anonymously via the Ethics Helpline (ethics@meridian.example) or the third-party reporting portal listed on the intranet.

All reports are reviewed by the Ethics Committee comprising the HR Head, Finance Controller, and an independent member of the Audit Committee.

Protection from Retaliation

No retaliation against a whistleblower acting in good faith is permitted. Retaliation itself is a disciplinary offence.

Identity of the whistleblower is protected to the maximum extent possible consistent with the requirements of a fair inquiry.

10. Acknowledgement

Annual Confirmation

All employees must acknowledge this Code annually through the HRMS portal. Failure to acknowledge by the published deadline may result in suspension of system access until completion.

Acknowledgement is a personal certification that the employee has read, understood, and will comply with this Code in spirit and in letter.

Training and Refreshers

An e-learning module covering the Code is rolled out annually and must be completed by all employees. Specific topics (POSH, anti-bribery) may have additional mandatory refreshers.